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BANC MSS 93/62 c : letters; April 27, 1906

William H. Chapman Letters relating to S.F. earthquake, April 27, 1906

April 27
My dear Margaret —

There is nothing new to write tonight just the same old grind. Lots of work but no variety. Things are straightening out slowly but it will be months before the machinery of the city is running smoothly again and I doubt if San Francisco ever gets back where it was before the earthquake.

I saw Gen. Cooldige yesterday. His home was not burned but was somewhat damaged. He said that Mrs. Coolidge was going East for a long visit and seemed uncertain as to whether he would remain in San Francisco or not.

Last evening I walked up Eddy to Van Ness and down past where Miss Cranna lived. Every thing [sic] is burned to Van Ness and in many places the houses are all down to the next street having been blown up to stop the progress of the fire. There is nothing at all left in the block where Miss Cranna's was. That large house on the corner opposite is still standing but is a wreck. Do you remember that immense brown stone house on the further side of Van Ness near Sacramento I think, a beautiful place? That is all to pieces. Things are in such a state that even people who live here have hard work recognizing the streets. It is awfully depressing. I wish that we could get away. There has been a high wind all day which has caused a great deal of danger from weak walls among the ruins. I had to close part of Powell St. and one block of Market just above here on account of dangerous condition of walls. People are such fools about going into dangerous places that I am surprised that there are not more accidents than do actually occur.

I have not received any mail since I have been here. If you have written the letters must have gone to the Presidio. Try addressing me at the Bank and if I am moved will send here for my mail. A great deal of love to you all

Will